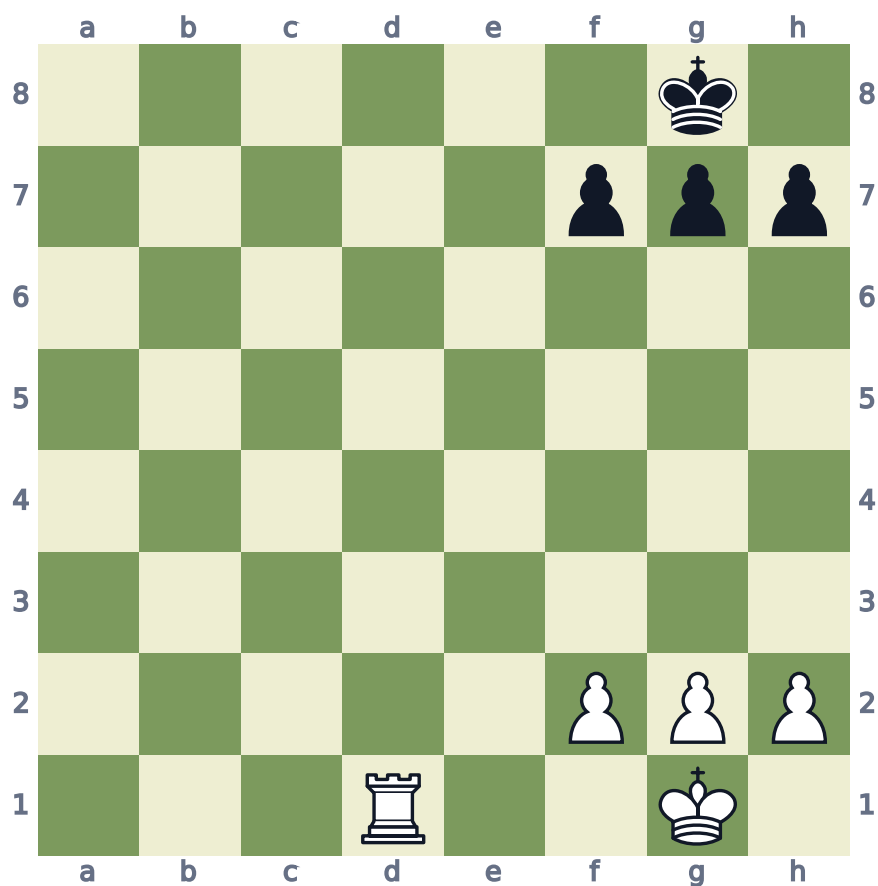


Fritz 21 Companion Pack

Turn the PDF library into interactive computer training



Use Fritz 21 to play positions, practice calculation, compare styles, analyze games, and work through the accompanying PGN and FEN files without becoming dependent on engine answers.

20 practice units | separated solutions | scoring | review plan

ORIENTATION

How to get real improvement from this course

PURPOSE

Use Fritz 21 to play positions, practice calculation, compare styles, analyze games, and work through the accompanying PGN and FEN files without becoming dependent on engine answers.

TRAINING RULES

- Study the PDF task before opening the engine window.
- Save your candidates and calculation in the game notation or a separate journal.
- Use the engine to test claims and uncover missed defenses, then rewrite the lesson in plain language.
- Keep online-only features separate from local training so the library remains useful without a subscription.

COURSE SIZE

This PDF contains 20 practice units. Problems appear before their solutions whenever practical. Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days.

WORKFLOW

The three-pass training loop

PASS 1 - HUMAN

Set the position, turn the engine off, write candidates, calculate, and evaluate.

PASS 2 - VERIFICATION

Start Fritz, compare multiple lines, locate the first divergence, and test the best defense.

PASS 3 - TRANSFER

Save one correction question, play the position from both sides, and schedule spaced review.

AVOID ENGINE DEPENDENCE

If you cannot explain why the engine move works, you have information but not yet knowledge. Return to the position, hide the line, and reconstruct the mechanism.

FRITZ WORKFLOW

Methods 1-2

01. CREATE A CLEAN TRAINING DATABASE

Keep imported positions, your games, and engine-checked solutions together. Use descriptive names and preserve the original unannotated game.

02. IMPORT THE COMPANION PGN

Open or import the supplied PGN so each training position appears as a separate entry with its starting FEN and task comment.

FRITZ WORKFLOW

Methods 3-4

03. PASTE OR SET UP A FEN

Use position setup when you want to begin directly from a diagram. Confirm side to move and castling rights before analysis.

04. ANALYZE UNAIDED FIRST

Write candidates and variations before starting an engine. Otherwise the engine answer can create familiarity without calculation skill.

FRITZ WORKFLOW

Methods 5-6

05. USE ASSISTED CALCULATION

Begin with guidance when the calculation process is new, then reduce help as the procedure becomes stable.

06. USE EVALUATED CALCULATION

Enter complete variations and let the program assess move quality after you finish your own tree.

FRITZ WORKFLOW

Methods 7-8

07. USE TACTICAL CALCULATION

Select positions where forcing geometry matters and compare whether you found the opponent's strongest defense.

08. TRAIN VISUALIZATION

Use blindfold or hidden-piece practice only at a depth where the internal board remains reliable.

FRITZ WORKFLOW

Methods 9-10

09. PLAY THE POSITION FROM BOTH SIDES

Defend the winning side's idea and attack the defensive setup. Reversing roles exposes shallow pattern memory.

10. ADJUST PLAYING STRENGTH

Choose a level that punishes real mistakes but still gives you repeated decisions and realistic chances to recover.

FRITZ WORKFLOW

Methods 11-12

11. CHOOSE AN OPPONENT STYLE

Use aggressive, positional, exchange-oriented, risk-taking, solid, or character-based opponents to practice specific discomforts.

12. TRAIN AGAINST LEGENDS

Treat legend simulations as style practice. Study the decisions they provoke rather than assuming the simulation reproduces a human perfectly.

FRITZ WORKFLOW

Methods 13-14

13. USE TACTICS FROM YOUR GAMES

Run tactical analysis after self-analysis and save positions where your candidate process failed.

14. USE ENDGAME TRAINING

Repeat essential positions until the winning or drawing method can be stated before the first move.

FRITZ WORKFLOW

Methods 15-16

15. USE BULLET TRAINING CAREFULLY

Train rapid recognition after the underlying patterns are understood; speed should compress a correct process, not replace it.

16. USE BLITZ AND TRAIN WORKSHEETS

Turn fast games into targeted review, but confirm every worksheet lesson with slower analysis.

FRITZ WORKFLOW

Methods 17-18

17. COMPARE MULTIPLE CANDIDATES

Use more than one engine line when you want to understand why a natural alternative is inferior, not only what the top move is.

18. RUN A SHOOTOUT

For unclear positions, let engines play the position out multiple times to test whether an evaluation converts in practice.

FRITZ WORKFLOW

Methods 19-20

19. USE OPENING BOOKS AS EVIDENCE

Frequency and score suggest what deserves study, but your repertoire still needs plans, transitions, and answers to sidelines.

20. MAINTAIN AN ERROR DATABASE

Tag each saved position by error cause and theme. Review the recurring cause rather than collecting endless engine variations.

POSITION CATALOG

Training positions 1-5

001. BACK-RANK MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
6k1/5ppp/8/8/8/8/5PPP/3R2K1 w - - 0 1

002. BACK-RANK MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
3r2k1/5ppp/8/8/8/8/5PPP/6K1 b - - 0 1

003. SMOTHERED MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
6rk/6pp/7N/8/8/8/6PP/6K1 w - - 0 1

004. SMOTHERED MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
6k1/6pp/8/8/8/7n/6PP/6RK b - - 0 1

005. ARABIAN MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
7k/R7/5N2/8/8/8/6K1 w - - 0 1

POSITION CATALOG

Training positions 6-10

006. ARABIAN MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
6k1/8/8/8/5n2/r7/7K b - - 0 1

007. EPAULETTE MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
5rkr/8/7Q/8/8/2B5/8/6K1 w - - 0 1

008. EPAULETTE MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
6k1/8/2b5/8/8/7q/8/5RKR b - - 0 1

009. LADDER MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
k7/1R6/2K5/8/8/8/8/7R w - - 0 1

010. LADDER MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
7r/8/8/8/2k5/1r6/K7 b - - 0 1

POSITION CATALOG

Training positions 11-15

011. QUEEN BOX MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
7k/8/5KQ1/8/8/8/8 w - - 0 1

012. QUEEN BOX MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
8/8/8/8/5kq1/8/7K b - - 0 1

013. ROOK BOX MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
7k/8/6K1/8/8/8/R7 w - - 0 1

014. ROOK BOX MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
r7/8/8/8/6k1/8/7K b - - 0 1

015. ROOK-AND-BISHOP BACK RANK

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
6k1/5ppp/8/8/1B6/8/4R1K1 w - - 0 1

POSITION CATALOG

Training positions 16-20

016. ROOK-AND-BISHOP BACK RANK - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
4r1k1/8/1b6/8/8/8/5PPP/6K1 b - - 0 1

017. QUEEN-AND-BISHOP BATTERY

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
7k/6pp/8/8/8/2B5/6Q1/6K1 w - - 0 1

018. QUEEN-AND-BISHOP BATTERY - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
6k1/6q1/2b5/8/8/8/6PP/7K b - - 0 1

019. QUEEN-AND-KNIGHT MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
7k/6pp/5N2/8/4Q3/8/8/6K1 w - - 0 1

020. QUEEN-AND-KNIGHT MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
6k1/8/8/4q3/8/5n2/6PP/7K b - - 0 1

POSITION CATALOG

Training positions 21-25

021. DOUBLE-BISHOP MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
7k/5Kpp/8/4B3/8/2B5/8/8 w - - 0 1

022. DOUBLE-BISHOP MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
8/8/2b5/8/4b3/8/5kPP/7K b - - 0 1

023. ROOK-AND-BISHOP CORRIDOR

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
6k1/6pp/3N4/1B6/8/8/K3R3 w - - 0 1

024. ROOK-AND-BISHOP CORRIDOR - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
k3r3/8/8/1b6/3n4/6PP/6K1 b - - 0 1

025. BACK-RANK MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
6k1/5ppp/8/8/8/5PPP/3R2K1 w - - 0 1

POSITION CATALOG

Training positions 26-30

026. SMOTHERED MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
6k1/6pp/8/8/8/7n/6PP/6RK b - - 0 1

027. EPAULETTE MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
5rkr/8/7Q/8/8/2B5/8/6K1 w - - 0 1

028. LADDER MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
7r/8/8/8/2k5/1r6/K7 b - - 0 1

029. ROOK BOX MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN:
7k/8/6K1/8/8/8/8/R7 w - - 0 1

030. ROOK-AND-BISHOP BACK RANK - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN:
4r1k1/8/1b6/8/8/8/5PPP/6K1 b - - 0 1

POSITION CATALOG

Training positions 31-35

031. QUEEN-AND-KNIGHT MATE

Goal: White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied. FEN: 7k/6pp/5N2/8/4Q3/8/8/6K1 w - - 0 1

032. DOUBLE-BISHOP MATE - REVERSED COLORS

Goal: Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation. FEN: 8/8/2b5/8/4b3/8/5kPP/7K b - - 0 1

033. ROOK SKEWER - REVERSE VIEW

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 4r1k1/8/8/8/8/8/8/Q5K1 b - - 0 1

034. KNIGHT DOUBLE ATTACK - REVERSE VIEW

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 6k1/8/8/8/4n3/8/8/3QK3 b - - 0 1

035. LOOSE QUEEN

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 6k1/8/8/3q4/8/2N5/8/6K1 w - - 0 1

POSITION CATALOG

Training positions 36-40

036. ROOK SKEWER

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: q5k1/8/8/8/8/8/4R1K1 w - - 0 1

037. BISHOP SKEWER

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 7k/8/8/8/8/4B3/8/q5K1 w - - 0 1

038. PAWN FORK

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 6k1/3r1r2/8/4P3/8/8/8/6K1 w - - 0 1

039. PAWN FORK - REVERSE VIEW

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 6k1/8/8/8/4p3/8/3R1R2/6K1 b - - 0 1

040. CAPTURE WITH CHECK - REVERSE VIEW

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 6k1/8/8/8/8/8/1q6/R5K1 b - - 0 1

POSITION CATALOG

Training positions 41-45

041. ROYAL FORK

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: q3k3/8/8/1N6/8/8/8/6K1 w - - 0 1

042. BACK-RANK GEOMETRY

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 6k1/5ppp/8/8/8/8/4QPPP/3R2K1 w - - 0 1

043. PROMOTION TACTIC

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 4k3/P7/8/8/8/8/7q/6K1 w - - 0 1

044. CAPTURE WITH CHECK

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: r5k1/1Q6/8/8/8/8/8/6K1 w - - 0 1

045. ROOK DOUBLE ATTACK - REVERSE VIEW

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: r5k1/4Q3/8/8/8/8/8/4K3 b - - 0 1

POSITION CATALOG

Training positions 46-50

046. DISCOVERED ATTACK

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 3q2k1/8/8/3N4/8/8/8/3R2K1 w - - 0 1

047. ROYAL FORK - REVERSE VIEW

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 6k1/8/8/8/1n6/8/8/Q3K3 b - - 0 1

048. LOOSE QUEEN - REVERSE VIEW

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 6k1/8/2n5/8/3Q4/8/8/6K1 b - - 0 1

049. PROMOTION TACTIC - REVERSE VIEW

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 6k1/7Q/8/8/8/8/p7/4K3 b - - 0 1

050. BACK-RANK GEOMETRY - REVERSE VIEW

Goal: Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution. FEN: 3r2k1/4qppp/8/8/8/8/5PPP/6K1 b - - 0 1

VERSION NOTE

Official features and sources

FRITZ 21 FEATURES USED HERE

The official 2026 product materials describe style and legend opponents, calculation and bullet training, tactics and endgame training, opening books, positional analysis, and a three-month Premium period. Interface labels can change with updates.

OFFICIAL REFERENCES

- https://fritz21.chessbase.com/index_en.html
- <https://support.chessbase.com/en/content/details/CBAccount/aef763a6-75d4-40a4-b867-4595acb74911>
- <https://support.chessbase.com/en/content/details/ChessPrograms/315ff5c4-101b-4ea2-bb5b-db6df1f03a3e>
- <https://support.chessbase.com/en/content/details/ChessPrograms/97bb835e-9930-46c4-80e3-76bee4373d83>

LOCAL VERSUS ONLINE

The PDFs, FEN file, PGN files, local engine analysis, and ordinary position practice remain useful without Premium. LiveBook, Let's Check, Playchess, web apps, remote resources, and some cloud-linked conveniences depend on internet access or account services.